version-rc0

not another **sketch show**!

czech list

- ❑ 1 actor should play a "straight man" (ie, have their normal voice) in each sketch
- ❑

typographical conventions

- ➢ intonation going ↑*up* and ↓*down*
- ➢ emphasis *here*, and even more *here*
- ➢ read bits ⇤*written like this*⇥ slowly/drawn-out
- ➢ a line like —— means <*leave gap for other character to say somat*>

cast: *[toby]* ~ *[lexi]* ~ *[ben]*

herein is...

- ➢ [1] bottom-end of the market
- ➢ [2] lord shellsbury tax-evasion (shellsbury #1)
- ➢ [3] everyday english
- ➢ [4] a brief message from our sponsor
- ➢ [5] model candidate
- ➢ [6] hr e-training 2026
- ➢ [7] checkout number 5
- ➢ [8] granny top-shelf
- ➢ [9] divorce by tannoy
- ➢ [10] shakespeare was irish
- ➢ [11] five go carbon-neutral (shellsbury #2)
- ➢ [12] eau de slough
- ➢ [13] checkout number 6
- ➢ [14] emotional maintenance
- ➢ [15] dictionary corner

[1] bottom-end of the market

length: ~ 1min
characters: [doctor] :ben, [patient] :toby
abstract: a house-buyer-come-doctor, has a poke around a *different* sort of property

[doctor] right, well; I'll umm... *show myself in*...
...gosh; it's spacious once you're *inside*, isn't it...
...although umm... quite *dark* actually...
...and it's, err... just the *one* entrance, is it?

[patient] ow, *aww*, hold on... that bit *hurt*...

[doctor] oh, you'd like to *stop* the prostate-exam now, *would you*?
<or> can I ask it this is your *first* prostate-exam with us, sir?

«sting»

[2] lord shellsbury tax-evasion (shellsbury #1)

length: ~ 3½ mins
characters: [newsreader] :ben, [reporter] :lexi, lord [shellsbury] :ben, [butler] :toby
abstract: imperilled by the new £2 million mansion tax, a posho tries to pass his manor-house off as a worthless hovel

« 3x BBC radio pips »

[newsreader] *deep; resonant* BBC news at 4 o'clock. The chancellor, Rachel *Reeves*, has set out plans in her budget to increase tax on properties, worth over £2million. Our ↑*political* correspondent ↑Damian Grammaticus↓, sends this report...

« fades in... → outdoor country ambience; birds chirping; distant rooks »

[reporter] we're here at the private estate of Lord *Shellsbury*, in Wiltshire. It's a *sizable* property, so I asked him for *comments*...

« ...abrupt stop »

[shellsbury] *stoutly; abruptly* I never *touched* her.

~3 seconds' silence...; confusion

[reporter] err... *no*; comments about the *house*...

[shellsbury] oh *that*...? *relieved* Oh...! oh *right*... well... come on *in*...
« huge wooden door creaks open/shut; echoes on voice/footsteps (like large hallway) »
cordially; affably ...as you can see, I *just* about get *by*, in *this* place...

[reporter] yes... er, will *your* property be subject to the new *tax*, Lord Shellsbury?

[shellsbury] *gormlessly* hmm...? *tax? *realises* err... ah, err; no... no — I mean *this* old place... *jocularly* *worthless*; it's practically *landfill*... actually.

[reporter] *taps table* what's *this* ...

[shellsbury] *hastily; worriedly; quietly* oww, err — don't touch that; it's... 17th-century; you can tell by the rococo legs... *realising his indiscretion* umm, no, but I mean there's a... umm... *falters* *damp*-problem.

[reporter] *pause...; deadpan* you mean... the Italian water feature, in the entrance-hall?

[shellsbury] *jovially* well... you say *tomäto*... I say...

[reporter] *pause...; deadpan* ...offshore Swiss *bank*-account?

[shellsbury] *aghast; muttering* *wh–*... how the ↑*ruddy-hell* d'you know about *that*...

[reporter] Lord Shellsbury — is that a *moat* I can see out the window?

[shellsbury] *moat?* I *think* you'll find, thət *that* is a... *hesitation* *plumbing* leak. It got out-of-hand... so I had to deploy... umm, *security*-swans in it.

«
a door opens, revealing a high-society ball happening in neighbouring room; string-quartet, clinking glasses; laughter; then overheard speech...

"another glass of Bollinger, Tarquin? Jolly good vintage!"

»

[reporter] er, Lord Shellsbury, is that a high-society *soiree*, being hosted in your *ballroom*?

[shellsbury] *tone of "how preposterous"* *soiree*! it's... it's a, a... *soup*-kitchen... for the homeless. We find a live string-quartet keeps the... *sheepishly* tramps form... rioting.

« bell »

[butler] uh, My Lord — I have ironed the pheasant-hunting tweeds.

[reporter] is this your *butler*...?

[shellsbury] *stuttering...* ahh... er, err... *good*; now, you see, Damian, I like to... open the house up, to local *method*-actors. It's part of a rehabilitation-scheme... *patronisingly* *isn't* it Jenkins? Now, do another line for the nice BBC man...

[butler] *awkwardly* erm... HMRC are at the front gates again, Sir.

[shellsbury] ahh... *improv!* Right, *excellent*! *playing along; loudly for the mic; melodramatically; wink-wink-nod-nod* Well you can tell those... "*tax collectors*" that I am but a humble pauper living in a skip.

[butler] they... have a warrant, Sir. And a clipboard.

[shellsbury] *desperate breath; frantically* oh *bugger*... it's not a drill. Blast & *damnation*... right... change of plan; *you two*: help me, set *fire* to the east *wing* — we have to de-*value* the property; it's the *only* way to satisfy HMRC!

« fire blaze »

[reporter] *in characteristic news-reporter intonation* er... Damian Gramaticus, BBC news, Wiltshire — currently being handed a *petrol*-can, by a peer of the *realm*.

« sting »

[3] everyday english

length: ~ 3mins
characters: french [narrator] :lexi, [holly] :ben, [arabella] :toby
abstract: a purportedly innocuous english-for-french-speakers course, is promptly subverted by an aristocratic family row. The french narrator continually interrupts, until holly has had enough.

«pre-recorded random person, with background hubbub» *nonchalantly* Well, *you* know; there simply *aren't* any *realistic* english courses for the *French*, these days... I mean they come *over here* with a *completely* unrealistic impression... so *I* just want something representing what *everyday* life in modern Britain, is *actually like*...

«chime»

[narrator] *french* *Écoutez... et répétez*; *~~english; newsreader-esque~~* Holly and *Arabella*, are having a domestic

[holly] *insufferably posh; vexed* Gett... *ait*...

[arabella] *obstinately* Noeoo... *yoou* gett ait...

[holly] *defensively* Wott are you *torking* abeit, arabella; etts *muyy* raynje-rowvúh

[narrator] **«ding»** *french* *uh-Répétez la phrase*... *[holly]* etts *muyy* raynje-rowvúh **«ding»**

[arabella] *impetuously* Right... I'm taking the *car*-key! **«key-snatch»**

[holly] *incredulous gasp* How *dare* you! **«key-snatch»** *angrily* I'm cutting you ait of my *will*, you *waste*-of-a-*trust*-fund!

[arabella] uh! Gev it back, you psyco-betch!

[narrator] **«ding»** *french* *La phrase*... *[arabella]* gev it back you *psyco*-betch, *[narrator]* *...c'est un phrase populaire, pour description de la averagé englishman* **«ding»**

[holly] well, I'm driving to Fortnums... *without* you

[narrator] **«ding»** note *culturelle*: Fortnum and Mason — a small london corner-shop, where ordinary families pop in for a quick £200 tin of artisanal biscuits

[arabella] ...but you're down to your last 3000 in pocket-money...

[narrator] **«ding»** *Attention*. In la *Angleterre*, it is *customary* to keep £50 notes in the pockets, for blowing one's nose on.

[holly] *petulantly* well I can't ask *daddouy* for more; he's re-routing his pension-fund in the caymans

[narrator] **«ding»** *vocabulaire*: the "*cayman islands*" — a small costal suburb of Leeds, where traditional british families keep their money, to avoid the rain.

[holly] *disgusted* uh, what? Did he say *Leeds*!?

[arabella] is he *implying* we have structural ties to... *Yorkshire*?

[holly] hit the eject button, arabella — it's slander!

[arabella] I *can't*! The mechanism's *jammed*... gett me my phone

[narrator] **«ding»** *grammar* point: note how the average english citizen handles mild inconvienience, by immediately contacting their private samily solicitor *reactionary noises during following...*

«dialtones»

[arabella] Rupert? Yuh ett's Arabella... *pause* yuh, no, the pheasants are doings fine... Look, Rupert; I need you to buy the *language* institute, in Paris. Yuh... the whole thing — liquidate their assets, {~~destroy the pension-fund~~}, and have the voiceover man fired. **«confirmational ping»** ...*perfect*.

[holly] *leaning over tape-player; furious* good afternoon, *frenchy* — *I*, am your new majority shareholder. Répétez la phrase "*I am an unemployed peasant who will now walk home in the rain*"

[narrator] **«weak ding»** *shakily* err ...that concludes lesson *4* — do join us for lesson *5*: "*useful phrases for polishing your new employer's range-rover*"

~~***[holly]***, ***[arabella]*** ooo — that could be quite handy actually yuh~~

«sting»

[4] a brief message from our sponsor

length: ~ 1min
characters: [sophie] :lexi, [chris] :toby
abstract: two swindling therapy-coach podcasters, have found the perfect new sponsor

«bright/acoustic lifestyle music → fades out...»

[chris] *uncontrived, normal voice* ...before we get back to the true crime, I want to talk to you about *this* episode's sponsor, *Scurry*. Now; we're *all* busy, and we *all* have dreams. But *do* we have the time to learn 14th-century Mongolian *throat*-chanting, whilst doing our taxes?

[sophie] that's right — *no*. Well with the *Scurry* app, they've developed a patented, sub-harmonic algorithm, that syncs with your tax-return. Every time you input a deductible-*expense*, the app emits a low-frequency guttural-drone, that vibrates your kidney-stones into the shape of the Gobi desert.

[chris] ...and what's more, it's 100% organic. That's *Scurry* — use the code "BILE" *now*, for 10% off your first week of spontaneous personal-liquefaction.

[sophie] That's *B-I-L-E*, for 10% off. *Now* then Chris; where *were* we...

[chris], ***[sophie]*** *in unison; loud deep resonant throat-chanting* URGGGHHHH....

«sting»

[5] model candidate

length: ~ 3mins
characters: dave's [friend] :ben, interviewee [dave] :lexi, interviewer1 [i1] :toby, interviewer2 [i2] :ben
abstract: a gormless under-prepared job-seeker relies on an AI-connected earpiece for his interview. Reciting its output verbatim, he splurges sycophantic corporate waffle — only for his *earpiece* to be offered the job.

[friend] *concerned; frantic* what do you mean you haven't prepared? Dave, you're interviewing for "*Senior Risk Manager*" in 30 seconds!

[dave] *fumbling* wull; I just... ran out of time...

[friend] *reaching side of stage; exasperated sigh* uh. Well there's no time *now*; we're gonna have to use plan B. Right — take this *earpiece*. I've connected it up to *chat-GPT*. Now; you're gonna *go* into that interview, and just say *exactly* what you hear. Got it? *adamantly* These chatbots, are *infallible*. *Right*; go...

[dave] *confused/unconvinced; murmuring...*

«door-open-close»

[i1] ah; Dave! Take a seat...

[i2] *fumbling around with papers* Yes; let's jump straight in... *now* — why did you *apply*, to MegaBank Incorporated? *both interviewers keenly awaiting response*

[dave] *mutters* um, ok; just... hold on... *~3 seconds pause...*
gormless, unpunctuated, monotone Dave, that's *such* a great question. Here's a curated paragraph you can use straight in your interview: "*By empowering key stakeholders, and optimising market synergy, I'll achieve 15% workflow optimisation and value-added organic scalability for MegaBank.*" If you *want*, I can also generate ~~some~~ sentence-starters for their *follow-up* questions.

[i2] *looking askance and bewildered* r...right... *okay*...

[i1] *impressed* *precise*... structured... hyper-corporate — I *like* it...

[i2] Let's umm, *move on*... Can you tell us about your *previous experience*...?

[dave] *again nods, signals to wait, pause, then abruptly...* *I'm* sorry; that question violates my *privacy* protocols. Would you like me to write you a sonnet about accounting, in the style of a 17th-century pirate *instead*? *in pirate voice; enthusiastically...* *Ah, upon the salty ledger... of the deep blue sea — hiding the loot... from HMRC...*

[i2] *interrupting...* Umm... *no no*; that won't be necessary...

[i1] hmm, wow; GDPR compliance — it's all very impressive... If you'd just give us a *moment*, dave...
interviewers turn towards each other and confer in whispers ...

[i2] *loud whispering; frantically* he's a complete idiot! He's reading from a script in his ear!

[i1] I know... but it's *sensational*! This *earpiece* is the best candidate we've had in *years!* ...If only we could hire *it*, without... *him*...

[i2] hire the *earpiece* without him — what *nonsense*... we couldn't ever... well, *actually*... *pause; considers...* why can't we? Right... dave — tell your *earpiece* we'd like to offer *it* the role of {{Strategic Governance Director}} Senior Risk Manager at £120,000 a year... What does it say?

[dave] *excitedly* ooh! er... *buffers...* you have *reached* your message-limit for today; please upgrade to the plus-tier, or try again tomorrow.

[i1] hmm... playing hard-to-get....

[i2] right. Dave — take off the earpiece, leave it on the desk, and get out.

[i1] *condescendingly* oh... and *dave*...? On your way out, *could* you fetch the earpiece a flat-white? It's going to have a *very* busy first day.

«sting»

[6] hr e-training 2026

length: ~ 3mins
characters: computer [system] :ben, employee [dave] :toby
abstract: a waspish corporate e-Training platform attempts to inculpate a cautious employee, with a series of impossible politically-(in)correct questions.

«corporate jingle»

[system] *a smug, insincere, saccharine, robotic, infomercial voice*
Welcome to HR *e-Training* 2026...

[dave] *(reactionary murmurings throughout...)* *...oh, right... ok...*

[system] Question 1: You are sending a document to the office printer. Do you select... *(a)* black ink on *white* paper, or *(b)* white ink on black paper?

[dave] *lip-suck-open sound; caught off-guard; vacuously* ohh... um; well, suppose the... err, *black* ink on *white* paper — it's standard ain't it...

[system] *rapidly overlapping phrases* evaluating response... normalising variance... triangulating vectors... **«error-eh-urr»** Micro-aggression detected. You have reinforced institutional norms that black entities must perform all the work, whilst white backgrounds passively profit. *Deducting annual bonus*.

[dave] *reactionary noises* aw *what*?

[system] Question 2: A colleague in a wheelchair, has just delivered an *excellent* presentation. Do you...
(a) specifically highlight how their lived experience as a disabled person enriched the discussion... or,
(b) simply say "*Thanks that was really clear*", and move on?

[dave] *indignantly* huh, right — I'm not falling for *this* again; *proudly* *B*

[system] **«error-eh-urr»** performative compliance detected. You're only saying that to avoid looking biased — thereby objectifying their disability as a prop for virtue-signalling. *Assigning* diversity training...

[dave] oh you bugger!

[system] Question 3: On encountering a female colleague in the corridor, you *accidentally* notice that her *exceptionally-large* mammary glands, are poorly covered. Do you...
(a) explain that there is a cold *breeze* today, and she could be at-risk of hypothermia... or,
(b) neatly place a nearby *napkin* over the exposed area.

[dave] *befuddled; flustered; reluctantly* uh, well... I mean, *A* ...if I *had* to...

[system] **«error-eh-urr»** the *correct* answer was... "*C – other*".

[dave] *increasingly incensed* what?! That wasn't even an *option*! ...

[system] *obliviously* *Donating pension to CEO...*
Final question: *At* the staff christmas-party, you are catering for *yourself* and *several colleagues* — a gluten-intolerant *hindu* who only eats beef, a celiac *pastafarian* with a gastro-intestinal allergy to type-3 potassium nitrate, and a strict ~~non-kosher~~ vegan *adventist* with carnivorous tendencies on *Tuesdays*, *if* it's a leap-year. *Explain* how you would adequately meet *all* colleagues' requirements, using the staff fridge containing only 1 leftover pot-noodle, and a banana-skin.

[dave] *head-in-hands; protracted sign of anguish and defeat* *...arghhh*!

«sting»

[7] checkout number 5

length: ~ 1min
characters: [checkout] :ben, [shopper] :lexi
abstract: the "self-checkout" is in fact a bizarre, overzealously-voiced human. Owing to the medium of *radio* however, this is revealed to the audience only by the final line. (He also makes a comeback...)

«chime»

[checkout] *mimicking the intonation of a Sainsbury's digital self-checkout*
Welcome to *Sainsbury's*. Please... scan an *item*, or touch the *screen* to start.

[shopper] *pause — momentarily confused; murmuring* err... right, okay; err; *carrots*...

[checkout] *enthusiastic, resonant voice* BEEP

[shopper] err; *milk*...

[checkout] *slightly lower pitch; earnestly* ...*beep*...!

[shopper] ...and, umm; *bread*...

[checkout] ...*beep*.

[shopper] *wearily; bemusedly* kyoh, dear... uh, how do I *pay* then...

[checkout] *burstingly vivacious* Have you scanned your *nectar*-card?!

[shopper] *huffing* oh, right... ok, just need to put my *bags* down somewhere...

[checkout] *interrupting; eagerly* Unexpected *item*, in *bagging*-area...

[shopper] *explosive; exasperated* oh, *for goodness' sake*! dew know what... I think I'm just gonna use a self-*checkout* machine — you *are* the *most annoying* human cashier I've ever *met*.

«sting»

<< 2nd half of show >>

[8] granny top-shelf

length: ~ 1min
characters: [granny] :ben, [young-man] :lexi
abstract: ###

«shop bell dingle...»

[granny] ooh — young man; could you be a *darling* and help an old lady? I'm trying to reach... one of *those* on the top shelf...

[young-man] *obligingly* oh, well; of course... umm, *this* one?

[granny] oh no — the one *next* to it: *Twink Orgy 3*.
self-consciously what...??? It's for my *grandson*!

«sting»

[9] divorce by tannoy

length: ~ 2mins
characters: announcer1 [a1] :ben, announcer2 [a2] :lexi, [british-transport-police] :toby
abstract: a tetchy couple's not-so-subtle breakup unfolds in real-time, over a train-station PA system.

«(real-time?) reverb on announcers' voices»

[a1] **«ding-dong-1»** *automated deep resonant male voice* We are *sorry* to announce, that the sixteen-forty-*three* ... great-western *railway* service to ... ↑London ↓*Paddington*, is delayed by approximately *eighteen* minutes. *This* is because, the driver's *wife* left him this morning.

[a2] **«ding-dong-2»** *manual crackly announcement; female customer-service-esque voice* Err... this is an announcement for the passengers on platform *5*... er, just to say, the *wife* didn't actually leave *him*, because he started it with that night in the hotel... *thank you*.

[a1] *muttering; vexed* kyoh, the little *tike*... right; *clears throat* **«ding-dong-1»** This is a *platform*-alteration: would customers for the 16:43 service, please move to platform... *two* — so that the silly *announcement* woman, is out of *earshot*.

announcements now increasingly fast in response, & interrupting each other...

[a2] **«ding-dong-2»** Uh, passengers are *reminded* that *all* announcements at this station, *are* made by *fully*-qualified staff, *actually*... and that calling anyone "silly", would be bullying in the workplace.

[a1] *<murmuring>* *typical*... *</murmuring>* **«ding-dong-1»** Please note: unattended emotional-*baggage*, will be *removed* and *destroyed*. *This* train is formed of... 8 coaches; *wheelchair*-facilities in coach 5; *divorce*-lawyers in coach 7.

[a2] **«ding-dong-2»** *sharply; indignantly* Er, would customers please note, *(hurriedly...)* that you *don't* need a *DIVORCE* LAWYER, to see that custody of the *fondue*-set, belongs to the *wife*!

[a1] *murmuring; seething* *unbelievable*... **«ding-dong-1»** *This* train, is a *non-stopping* service *~interrupted~* to London Padd...

[a2] *furiously* Uh, passengers *are* advised that *not everything* at the hotel was "*non-stopping*"; *some* things went on for *quite some time*!! *in disbelief* I mean the *door* wasn't even *closed*, Gerald!!!

[a1] *breaks down; desperately; frantically* **«ding-dong-1»** but Barbra; I *need* you! My life is *empty* without you; I don't know how to *~interrupted~* carry *on*, without ...

[a2] *unapologetically; indignantly; climactically* well I'm *SORRY*, Gerald; you should have *THOUGHT* of that, before you **«beeped-out...»** ~~bonked~~ *Susan*, on the top of the *mini*-bar, you ~~feckless~~ ~~*bastard*~~ !!!

pause; silence; hold...

[a1] *sighs resignedly; deep breath* **«ding-dong-1»** Please... *mind* the gap... *interrupted*

[a2] *indignantly; explosively* ...BETWEEN YOUR *HOPES* OF A MARRIAGE, VS THE *REALITY* !!!

«whoosh»

[british-transport-police] *deep* That was a domestic-abuse *training* exercise, from the British transport-police — *see* it... *say* it... sorted out in court.

«sting»

[10] shakespeare was irish

length: ~ 2mins
characters: irish [teacher] :ben, student1 [s1] :lexi, student2 [s2] :toby
abstract: an incorrigibly-patriotic english teacher, makes series of farcical inferences from classic texts

«school-bell»

[teacher] *thick irish accent* right; *now* then class: who can tell me... *what* does shakespeare mean, by the line "*o spirit of love; how quick and fresh art thou*"?

[s1] well, err... is it the *duke*, wallowing in his unrequited love for *olivia*?

[teacher] err... well; I can see why you might *think* that, but err... *anyone else*...?

[s2] yes — isn't it the *self-pity*, of unreciprocated fervour?

[teacher] *huffs; muttering; jadedly* oh, *dear*; *some* things just can't be taught...
as if obvious... *right*; look... the *5th* letter of {"*spirit*"} is {"*i*"}; an {"*i*"} looks like a {*shamrock*}; {*shamrocks*} are from {*ireland*}; shakespeare *was* *irish*. Okay? He's *trying* to tell us, you see...?

[s1], ***[s2]*** *exasperatedly; murmuring...* oh, not *this* again...

[teacher] oh — *to-be-sure*, *to-be-sure*, *to-be-sure* he was irish! Right; *think* about it: "*shakespeare*" — it's a corruption of the gaelic "*Seán O'Sheare*" — he was a fisherman from county-*Cork*, for goodness' sake!

[s2] ohh, miss — that's *ridiculous*! *resignedly* Well look, what about this line from *Dickens*: "*I have been bent and broken, [...] but into a better shape*"...

[teacher] Charles Dickens? You mean *Charlie O'Dickens* from county-Mayo?
Those ⇤*Great Expectations*⇥ were him waiting for the *potatoes* to grow! Do your research boy!

[s1] *wearily; despairingly* oh, this is hopeless...
uhh, err... right... *stutter/hesitate, then realisation...* *hold on*...
shrewdly; thoughtfully *miss*... if shakespeare... *really were* irish... wouldn't he want us to *stop* studying... and go to the *pub* — to discuss the harvest, over a pint of guinness...?

[teacher] *perplexedly; faltering/hesitating...* err, *well*... I *suppose*... well I mean *if err*... *pause*
oh, you're right!
excitedly class dismissed! I'll see you all down at *O'Flaherty's Tavern* in ten!!

«sting»

[11] five go carbon-neutral (shellsbury #2)

length: ~ 2½ mins
characters: lord [shellsbury] :ben, tape [narrator] :toby
abstract: a sententious empire-nostalgic traditionalist is soon disabused of his brexiteer comforts. (The conceit being that shellsbury is *so* ignorant, that he regards "bisexuality" and "oat-milk", as 2 sides of the same coin.)

«fade in → sophisticated classical music»

[shellsbury] *stiff-upper-lip voice; documentry-style tone* I'm... Lord Shellsbury; *disgraced* politician, evicted ~~former~~ *mansion*-owner, and *5th* cousin *2wice*-removed, to the *8th* earl of *Ploppingtonshire*. And when *I've* finished a shift on GB-News, ⇤battling the *woke*-brigade⇥, I like to *escape* the lefty-liberal nonsense, with a good-old *Enid Blyton* audio-tape... **«music fades out...; cassette-insert, clunk, faint-hiss»** so... let's see now; just pop it in, and...

concurrently: [narrator] reads, [shellsbury] makes reactionary soothed "ahh... oh, yes..." mutterings...

[narrator] *soft analogue tape voice* >>>	***[shellsbury]*** >>>
It was a *mild* afternoon, and the *Famous Five* were gathered on Kirrin island. The sun was glowing with the reassuring warmth of a *freshly-ironed* union jack.	
———	ahh... *bliss*...
"*Who'd* like a pork-pie?", asked Julian. "Oh, *spiffing*!", said Dick; "I'll use my ceremonial *teaspoon*, engraved with the words «*No Euro Nonsense*»".	
———	oh, good boy Dick; God save the King...
As the vicar cycled by, with the harvest-festival *turnips*, Julian felt the ⇤*waft* of sovereignty *itself*⇥ descend upon them. "↑*Now*...", said Julian, looking out across the english-channel; "as you *know*, I've gathered you here to make an *announcement*..."	
———	yes... gunboats! Call in the navy...
"Oh! *Is* it about your campaign to privatise the village *duck*-pond?", asked George. "Or, about the immediate reinstatement of the british-*empire*?", proposed Anne.	
———	*staggered breathing in titillation* ohh... tell me more!
"Uh, not *this* time; no...", replied Julian; "*Everybody*... *I've* been *sleeping* with Rodger! We've been *bonking* on the village-green for months!". "↑*Oh yes*...", said Julian; "I'm *bisexual* now... *and* polyamorous".	
———	*suddenly aghast; huffing/puffing noises of disbelief* what! *what*?
"Oh, *sister*!", exclaimed Dick, dropping his ceremonial teaspoon. "*#boyfriendgoals*!!!", hailed George.	no! *no*! Turn it *off*!!
———	
"Anyone for some gluten-free plant-based *tofu*-cake?", offered Anne... "...or an oat-milk latte? It's all ethically-*sourced*".	*vegans*?!!
———	*scared* small *boats*?? On *Kirrin* island!!!
"ooh! can I have some *extra* for my friends on the small-boats from calais?", squealed Dick; "I've had their asylum applications ↑*fast*-tracked!"	

suddenly cut-off

«cassette-tape being ejected & ripped out»

[shellsbury] The *marxists!* They've *weaponised* Enid Blyton! They're putting pronouns in the ginger-beer!
few more seconds of incensed huffing...
...subsides into a melancholy silence...
...finally; protracted sigh of exhausted lamentation... ohhh...
3-second pause; concedingly; perkily Still... #*boyfriendgoals*.

«sting»

[12] eau de slough

length: ~ 2mins
characters: [director] :toby, [céline] :ben
abstract: if *english* perfume advertisements are in *french*, then why not umgekehrt?

«accompanying wafty music»

[céline] *breath-y, sexy, accent-heavy, whisper* *uh*-Jean-Pierre; tu es mon *seul* amour. Sous le ciel de *Paris*, nous nous échappons. Une lumière qui ne s'éteint jamais. C'est la fragrance... *J'adore*.

«music stops»

[director] *abruptly; congratulatorily* ...and, *cut*! *nonchalantly* Right! Well done everybody... well that's all we need... for the *english* version! So... onto the... *french* one; ~~let's just get this...~~

[céline] uh, *pardon*... err-what do you mean, a "*french*" version?

[director] well... *obviously*! Perfume ads in *england* are in *french* — because we find it charming and sophisticated. So, *naturally*... the *french* adverts, are in *englisch* — for exactly the same reason. *Look*; the agency felt the raw, untamed romanticism of Slough would really speak to a parisian audience.

[céline] *sceptically* err... e-*Slough*? *Qu'est-ce que c'est*...?

[director] well turn the script over, Céline — "*Slough*" is to a *parisian*, what "*Versailles*" is to a londoner! *assertively* Right — track 2; let's roll...

«restart same wafty music»

[céline] *incongruous french-bordering-on-russian accent* uh-*Steve*; you are ze only one for me... Best fork-lift-truck driver in ze land.... No-vun moves pallets of economy-range baked-beans like *you* do... Let us run *away* to... *Milton Keynes* multi-storey *carpark*. Ze light that never goes out... at the 24-hour Asda. Steve, you are not just a man; you are... *Senior Logistics Supervisor*, with full pension-contribution — *J'adore*.

«music stops»

[director] *flatly <OR?> moved to tears* oh, *sublime* — it'll be *flying* off the shelves in Bordeaux!!

«sting»

[13] checkout number 6

length: ~ 1min
characters: [checkout] :ben, [shopper] :lexi
abstract: the bizarre, overzealously-voiced human checkout, makes a comeback. In a confessional box.

«wooden door closes»

[shopper] forgive me father, for I have sinned. It has been 3 weeks since my last...

[checkout] *interrupting* Welcome to *holy reconciliation*! Please... select your *sin*, or touch the *crucifix* to start...

[shopper] *lividly* oh for *goodness' sakes* — not *you* again!!!

«sting»

[14] emotional maintenance

length: ~ 2mins
characters: [father] :ben, [son] :lexi
abstract: a son goes to spend the weekend with his emotionally-illiterate divorced dad

«dainty music → fades out...»

[father] right; well, son... *resentfully* your *mother*, has sent you to stay with *me* this weekend; so err... *begrudgingly; uneasily* I thought we could talk about, err... *cough* *emotions* *cough* *stiltedly* so, err... are you being *bullied* at school...?

[son] *apathetically; awkwardly; pause...* oh; umm... no not *really*...

[father] *disappointed* oh, you're... you're *not*? *muttering; ungraciously* okay... *worth a try*... Umm; right, are you *depressed*?

[son] *nonchalantly* err... well, yeah — a bit, yeah

[father] *excitedly* oh, you *are*? Oh fantastic! Right, okay... have you tried, umm... *bolting it in*?

[son] *as if he resignedly knows the father is hopeless* err... yeah... doesn't really *do* it for me, dad.

[father] *crestfallen* oh... usually works. *resolutely* Right, *depressed*... okay umm — is it a *constant* rattle, or more of a low-grade *hum*? *eagerly* Oh — have you tried *WD-40*? Oh, no wait; that's for hinges... *interrupted* ~~Well what about~~...

[son] *expostulatively* look; dad — you know it's *okay* to talk about emotions...

[father] *flustered* *phuwpf*... er, steady *on*, son — err, alright; how about a *brisk* walk; until your *knees* click? *stoutly* That's what your *grandad* did... he didn't have *feelings*, son — just an intense interest in *birdwatching*, and a mild *drink* problem.

[son] *indulgently* right... er, *thanks* for that, dad.

[father] *pleased* right... well that's *that* sorted for another year then... now; how's about we sit in silence and watch this 4-hour documentary, on the history of the *concrete*-industry...?

[son] *resignedly; consolingly; SIGHS* *ahh*... alright dad; I'll get the *biscuits*...

«sting»

[15] dictionary corner

length: ~ 3mins
characters: [quizmaster] :ben, [alistair] :lexi, [giles] :toby
abstract: a game of one-up-man-ship between two sesquipedalian interlocutors — each with an unerring, deadpan conviction that there exist some revered mornington-crescent-style, centuries-old rules, on which depend their intellectual reputations. It is incrementally revealed that the quizmaster has an infatuated crush on giles.

[quizmaster] *impassive, deadpan; calmly* ok gentlemen; we'll be playing by the 1937 *Montgomery* rules... so, no latinate-suffixes after 4 PM, and of course the *Schopenhauer Block*, is in play. Er, *Alistair*; you have the opening syllable...

[alistair] *audibly prizes lips open; draws slow breath in, as if carefully selecting weapon* ...vociferate.

[giles] *pause* implicature.

[quizmaster] *in tone of "careful now"...* ohh...

[alistair] unimpugnable.

[giles] *accusatorily* uh, *check*!

[quizmaster] *wincing* oww... yes he's *right*, I'm afraid; under the *1994 Lichfield-Amendment*, you can't use an adverb, following a superlative-participle in the future-tense. So... penalty-syllable to, *err*... *affectionately* *Giles*...

[giles] *indignantly; virtuously* hmm; yes, um... diastolic.

[alistair] paroxysm.

[giles] *vouchsafingly; patronisingly, but pretending not to care* umm... okay, yeah no I mean it's a bit *basic* isn't it, but no; we'll take it... *interrupted* ~~you've got to start *somewhere*~~...

[quizmaster] *attempting to mask his overt giles-favouritism* ...err, *yeah*; no... he's *right* actually, Alistair — it is a *bit* basic... ~~but err...~~

[alistair] *aggrievedly; persecutedly; affrontedly; not explosively* *what*...? but I... *dismissively; calming down...* okay... *hewn*.

[giles] Er, cementitious.

[alistair] benighted.

[giles] apoplectic.

[quizmaster] *fawningly* ah... absolute classic, Giles... no I mean *I* would have used that in... well, it would have been '84... '85...? No, very well *done*...

[alistair] *wearily; muttering; rolling eyes* *oh... for goodness' sakes*... *collecting himself* tergiversate.

[quizmaster] *grimacing lip-suck* *oww... careful*, Alistair — well, 'cause you... you nearly triggered the *Unlicensed Subjunctive Act of 1892*... there, so...
[giles] *affirmingly* yeh... yeah...

[alistair] *plaintively* well this is *ridiculous*! That was a *perfectly* legal vowel-shift, but *you* were busy eyeing-up his syntax!

[quizmaster] *affrontedly* err... *sorry*, Alistair; is there a *problem*...?

[alistair] *plaintively* look! I just can't help noticing that you *swooning* over giles, has given him an unfair *advantage*! I mean you've turned a serviceable game of the *Montgomery* rules, into a nauseating display of sycophantic *erotomania*!

[quizmaster] *pseudo-authoritative voice* uh, well... I'm *afraid* that triggers... umm, *Article... 83*... err...

[giles] *proudly* ...*emotional-incontinence*...

[quizmaster] ...er, yes; emotional-incontinence, actually, Alistair... ~~so...~~

[alistair] *resolutely* well then: I'm invoking *Clause 39* — the Interstitial Abscondment... good *riddance*!

alistair storms out...
«heavy door slams»
tense silence...

[giles] *slowly; amorously* so... if he's *gone*... does *that mean*...?

[quizmaster] *quivering* *oh yes*... *lasciviously; passionately* I want to *excumbriate* your glandulant *fossiducts*, Giles! *Erumpently*... *limbodaceously*. I want to *conticulate* your tumescent clevities, culminating in a vocalic suffusion of our *cleviculli*, or even... an intra-sinuous paroxysm of lubricous-*engorgement*...

[giles] *sharp intake of breath; lustfully* ...I'll get the *dictionary*!

«sting»

end titles

Not Another Sketch Show was written and performed by Ben Mullan, Lexi Hamilton, and Toby Smillie. The recording-engineer was ###, and the music was by ###. It was a *Drama* production, for *XpreßionFM*.

...and now it's over.